

UNIT 3

COMMON SHORT KEYS YOU MUST KNOW



Learning Objectives

By the end of this unit, students will be able to:

- 1. Understand the importance of using short keys.**
- 2. Memorize commonly used short keys in MS Word and MS Excel.**
- 3. Apply short keys in practical scenarios for enhanced productivity.**

Short keys, also called **keyboard shortcuts**, make working on a computer faster and more efficient. Instead of using a mouse for every action, you can perform tasks quickly by pressing a combination of keys. They save time by replacing mouse-based commands with quick key presses.

This chapter introduces important shortcuts used in MS Word, MS Excel, and general computer tasks..

Why Do We Learn Short Keys?

- **Saves Time:** Short keys speed up tasks like copying and pasting.
- **Increases Productivity:** They make repetitive tasks easier.
- **Reduces Effort:** They minimize the need to switch between the keyboard and mouse.



Short Keys for MS Word

MS Word is a popular tool for creating documents.

These short keys will make writing and editing easier:

Action	Short keys
copy	Ctrl+C
paste	Ctrl+V
cut	Ctrl+X
undo	Ctrl+Z
redo	Ctrl+Y
bold text	Ctrl+B
italic text	Ctrl+I
under-line text	Ctrl+U
save Document	Ctrl+S
open a new Document	Ctrl+N
print Document	Ctrl+P
Find text	Ctrl+F
Replace text	Ctrl+H
Select all	Ctrl+A

Short Keys for MS Excel

MS Excel is used for managing data and performing calculations. These shortcuts will help you work more efficiently:

Action	Short keys
insert new sheet	Shift + F11
Auto sum	Alt + =
open save as dialog box	F12
move to next sheet	Ctrl + Page Down
move to previous sheet	Ctrl + Page Up
Add or Edit Comment	Shift + F2
Highlight Entire Column	Ctrl + Space
Highlight Entire Row	Shift + Space
Edit Selected Cell	F2
Refresh Data	Alt + F5
Close workbook	Ctrl + w

General Short Keys for Computers

Action	Short key
Minimize All Window	Window + D
Switch between programs	Alt + Tab
Take a Screen shot	Window + Shift + S
Lock computer	Window + L
Open File Explorer	Window + E
Search for a file or App	Window + S
Refresh page or desktop	F5
Open Task Manager	Ctrl + Shift + Esc
Print a Document	Ctrl + P

Fun Fact

The **Ctrl + Z** shortcut, which undoes actions, is often called the "magic key" for fixing mistakes!

EXERCISES

01: Choose the correct answer.

1. The shortcut for copying text is:

- ☐ Ctrl + X
- ☐ Ctrl + C
- ☐ Ctrl + P

2. Which shortcut opens Task Manager?

- ☐ Ctrl + Alt + Del
- ☐ Ctrl + Esc
- ☐ Ctrl + Shift + Esc

3. To italicize text in MS Word, use:

- ☐ Ctrl + U
- ☐ Ctrl + I
- ☐ Ctrl + B

4. To highlight an entire row in MS Excel, press:

- ☐ Ctrl + Space
- ☐ Alt + Space
- ☐ Shift + Space

5. The shortcut to lock your computer is:

- ☐ Windows + S
- ☐ Windows + Tab
- ☐ Windows + L

6. The shortcut to refresh a page is:

- ☐ Alt + F4
- ☐ F5
- ☐ Ctrl + R

02: Fill in the blanks.

1. To save a file in MS Word, press _____.
2. _____ is used to undo an action.
3. The shortcut for opening File Explorer is _____.
4. To take a screenshot, press _____.
5. _____ is the shortcut for printing a document.
6. In MS Excel, you can auto-sum a column using _____.

03: Write 'True' or 'False'.

	TRUE	FALSE
Ctrl + F is used to find text in a document.	☐	☐
Alt + Tab locks your computer.	☐	☐
Shift + Space highlights an entire row in Excel.	☐	☐
Windows + L minimizes all windows.	☐	☐
F12 is the shortcut for saving a document.	☐	☐
Ctrl+ Shift+ S is used to take a screenshot.	☐	☐

04: Answer the following questions.

1. Name two shortcuts commonly used in MS Excel.
2. Write the shortcut to lock your computer.
3. How do you open Task Manager using a shortcut?
4. List and describe five shortcuts for MS Word.
5. What are the advantages of using short keys in MS Excel?
Provide examples.
6. Differentiate between the shortcuts **Ctrl + Z** and **Ctrl + Y**.

[illegible]

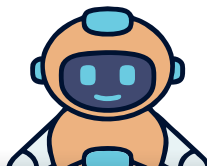
05: Match the short keys on the left with their corresponding actions on the right.

Short key
Ctrl + C
Ctrl + V
Ctrl + B
Ctrl + X
Ctrl + Z
Ctrl + N
Ctrl + S
Ctrl + P
Ctrl + I
Alt + Tab

Action
undo the last action
Open a new Document in MS Word
paste the copied content
Save the current document
Bold selected text
Cut the selected text or image
Copy the selected text or image
Switch between open applications
Italicize selected text
Print the document

LAB ACTIVITIES

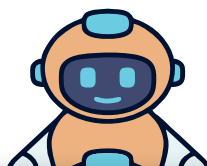
Lab Activity 1: Practise in MS Word



Open a new document, type a paragraph on "Benefits of using keyboard shortcuts", and use **Ctrl + B**, **Ctrl + I**, and **Ctrl + U** to format text.

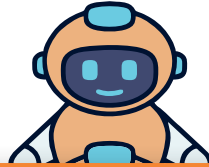
- Use **Ctrl + F** to find a specific word in the document.

Lab Activity 2: Practise in MS Excel



- Create a new spreadsheet and use **Alt + =** to calculate the sum of a column.
- Insert a comment using **Shift + F2** in a cell.

Lab Activity 3: Practise general short keys



- Minimize all windows using **Windows + D**.
- Lock the computer with **Windows + L** and log back in.

